# FoodShare – App Flow

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## Authentication and onboarding

Every visitor either signs up with a role or logs in; the role decides the first screen.

1. Open the landing page and choose **Sign up** or **Log in**.
2. Sign up: enter name, email, password, then pick a role (Donor, Receiver or Volunteer). Donors and receivers add an organisation name.
3. The server creates the account and returns a token; the client stores it and opens the socket connection.
4. The app asks the browser for location (needed for the nearby feed and the map pin) or lets the user type an address.
5. The user lands on their role home: Donor on Post surplus, Receiver on Nearby feed, Volunteer on Pickup board.

Log in follows steps 3 to 5. An invalid token or an expired session returns the user to the login screen.

## Donor flow

1. Tap **Post surplus**.
2. Enter title, category, quantity in kg and expiry time; add a short pickup note.
3. Confirm the pickup location (current location, typed address or a pin on the map).
4. Submit. The listing is created as Available and appears live in nearby feeds.
5. Watch the status in **My activity**: Claimed, In transit, Delivered.
6. If nobody has claimed it yet, the donor can **Cancel**; after a claim the button disappears.
7. After delivery, see the contribution on the impact dashboard.

## Receiver flow

1. Open the **Nearby feed**; the default radius is 5 km and the list is sorted nearest first.
2. Adjust radius and category filters; new listings appear live without refreshing.
3. Open a listing to see quantity, expiry countdown, donor and address.

4. Tap **Claim this food**. If another organisation claimed it first, a message explains and the card disappears.
5. The listing becomes Claimed and is shown to volunteers on the pickup board.
6. Follow the status stepper in **My activity** until Delivered, then confirm receipt.

## Volunteer flow

1. Open the **Pickup board**; it lists Claimed listings near the volunteer, nearest first.
2. Open one to see the pickup address, the drop-off receiver and the expiry.
3. Tap **Pick up**. The listing becomes In transit and is locked to this volunteer.
4. Collect the food from the donor and take it to the receiver.
5. Tap **Delivered** on arrival. The listing becomes Delivered and counts toward impact.
6. Return to the board for the next pickup. Delivery history appears in **My activity**.

## Edge cases and error handling

| Situation | What the user sees | System behaviour |
|---|---|---|
| Two receivers claim at once | Loser gets "Just claimed by another organisation" | Atomic update succeeds once; the other call returns 409 |
| Listing expires before claim | It leaves the feed; the donor is told it expired | Excluded by the expiry filter; optional job marks it cancelled |
| Claimed but no volunteer picks up | Receiver sees "Waiting for a volunteer" with elapsed time | Stays Claimed; future option to release the claim after a time limit |
| Volunteer opens a listing already picked up | "Another volunteer has this pickup" | Pickup returns 409 |
| Wrong role opens a restricted screen | Redirected to their home | API returns 403 |
| Location permission denied | Prompt to type an address | Feed uses the typed address coordinates |

| Situation | What the user sees | System behaviour |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Connection lost | "Reconnecting" indicator | Socket retries; feed refetched on reconnect |
| Token expired | Sent to log in, then back to where they were | API returns 401 |